



The Gwlad Manifesto

2026

**A Plan For Creating The Best
Possible Wales**

GWGLAD - OUR MANIFESTO

Introduction

Gwlad exists to obtain independence for Wales by removing the obstacles that currently stand in its way. In our view, the principal obstacle is Wales's relative poverty: whether compared to the rest of the UK or to other similarly-sized countries around the world.

Therefore, while independence is our goal, the Welsh economy is our priority.

We want independence simply because we believe that Wales is a nation. Being part of the United Kingdom for many centuries has eroded both our economy and our culture, and Wales's needs can never be a priority for governments in London.

The current devolution settlement, hailed so optimistically at its outset in 1999, has been a bitter disappointment. The Senedd has become the haunt of career politicians who pursue their own interests, largely free of scrutiny from voters and media channels who know that, even now, the real power is still in Westminster.

But in the right hands, the Senedd can still make a positive difference. Since the Wales Act 2017, the notional powers of the Welsh Government have been significantly extended: in particular, the situation has changed from "everything is reserved for Westminster unless it is specifically devolved" to "everything is devolved unless it is specifically reserved for Westminster". Even so, few if any people really understand where the boundaries lie.

Here we set out our practical, detailed proposals about how we can use the Senedd's powers, from May 2026 onwards, to start rebuilding the Welsh economy while safeguarding our integrity as a nation. We want to help Welsh people celebrate, and where necessary rediscover, their own history, culture and, yes, language.

For every policy area, there are three columns:

Firstly, what is wrong today? If you want to solve a problem, the first step is to identify what it is.

Secondly, what can we do *today*, using the existing constitutional structures of Welsh Government and Senedd within the United Kingdom? We may not be able to do everything we'd like to do, but we will not use our aspiration for independence as an excuse for not doing what we can in the meantime.

Thirdly, the difference that we think independence can make - the new horizons that will open up to a free Wales fully in control of its own destiny.

Our slogan is "Wales Can Be Better", and we mean it. It really can. This is our plan to make that happen.



Gwyn Wigley Evans
Party Leader.

Written and edited by Stephen Morris,
reflecting wide consultation amongst
the party membership via our members-
only online forum and in person.

Original version published on 11th
October 2025; minor revisions made in
February 2026.

Contents

Welfare and Taxation	1
Education.....	4
Civic Service	8
Health	9
Women’s Rights and Safeguarding	12
Adult Social Care.....	14
Economy	16
Access to Employment Opportunities.....	18
Regulation of Professional Roles	20
Transport	21
Tourism.....	23
Environment and Natural Resources.....	27
Policing and Justice.....	30
Housing.....	31
Property Tax Reform	34
Government and Democracy	35
Culture	38
Heritage	39
Media.....	41
Agriculture	41
Immigration and Residency.....	44
Defence.....	48
Relations with the European Union	49
Currency and Constitution	50
Coalition Government	53

Welfare and Taxation

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
When comparing the Welsh economy with the wider UK economy, two factors stand out: - Salaries in Wales are <i>much</i> lower than in the rest of the UK, even though the percentage of people in work is very similar and the unemployment rate is slightly lower. - Of those who are out of work, a significantly higher proportion in Wales are on <i>long-term</i> sickness benefits. This problem is, however, highly geographically concentrated in post-industrial areas such as Blaenau Gwent, Torfaen and Llanelli. It is well-known that Wales has a 'fiscal deficit', with taxes raised in Wales falling short of the amount the government spends. This is the single biggest financial obstacle to independence, and the reasons become clear when the composition of the Welsh workforce is analysed: in Wales (2024 figures), 89% of	The Welsh Government only has very limited powers to alter the income tax system in Wales. Tax thresholds cannot be changed, but tax rates within the various tax brackets can be varied by $\pm 10\%$. Even so, we propose to use these powers to cut the tax rate for those earning over £125,140, from the UK rate of 45% down to 40% (i.e. the same rate as that paid by workers earning over £50,270). Since there are currently so few people in this bracket, such a change will initially have a minimal impact to the total income tax raised in Wales (we estimate about £45 million from a total of £2,968 million, or 1.5%). However, we expect this to have two specific benefits: - It will encourage more higher-earners to move to Wales, quickly making up the shortfall and allowing Wales to benefit from the experience and investment potential they would bring with them. We would specifically encourage those from the Welsh diaspora to take advantage of the opportunity to save tax by moving home. - It will go some way to correct the impression of Wales that many people outside the country have, namely a place that is hostile to wealth and to private-sector businesses. The Welsh Government has no power at all over benefit entitlements such as Universal Credit (UC), state	We want to go on simplifying and streamlining the tax system, making Wales a more business-friendly environment and removing the disincentives for people to increase their incomes and grow the economy as a whole. A fundamental weakness of the UK's tax system is that people whose incomes are close to the boundaries between tax bands can actually become worse off if their salaries increase. To this end we propose an alteration the basis upon which income tax is calculated. It turns out that by: - replacing the current income tax band structure, and also employee National Insurance, with a fixed percentage applied to all income ('a flat tax') - then reducing the resulting tax calculation by a fixed cash amount for all taxpayers ('a fixed rebate') ... then there would be little or no change in the amount of tax that most people would pay, except that the kinks and anomalies in the present system would be eliminated. Actual collection of the amount, once calculated, would proceed in the same way as currently, through employer PAYE or completion of a Tax Return. Having abolished personal National Insurance contributions, entitlements to state pensions and other benefits which currently depend on them would instead be calculated according to overall taxes paid.

workers earned less than £50,270, so paid the lowest rate of income tax (20%). In the rest of the UK, only 83% were in this bracket. Those paying the 40% rate, with salaries less than £125,140, comprised 10% of the workforce in Wales compared to 14% in the wider UK. People earning over £125,140 and paying 45% tax numbered just 0.7% of the Welsh workforce, compared to 2.3% in the rest of the UK. Looked at another way, basic-rate taxpayers bore 54% of the tax burden in Wales, compared to 31% elsewhere in the UK, whilst the highest earners bore just 13% of the tax burden in Wales compared to 27% elsewhere.¹ Having so few high-earners in Wales matters: not only because of the proportion of the tax burden they bear, but also because these are the people most likely to establish job-	pensions or Personal Independence Payments (PIPs). There are minor powers related to cases of individual distress (e.g. supplying furniture or white goods) and local authority payments such as free school meals. Any wider-ranging changes to benefits are outside the Welsh Government's scope, and may in any case not be practical without control of our border because of the risk of 'benefits tourism'.	Even so, we advocate that a percentage of taxes gathered would be earmarked as "State Health Insurance" in order to make more visible the connection between taxes raised and total public-sector health spending. Employer National Insurance contributions are already flat – the rate is the same (15% at the time of writing) at all levels of earned income². Therefore we do not propose changing the existing mechanism – though we may give it a less misleading name - but it would be our ambition to manage the economy in such a way that we could reduce the rate. Following the example of jurisdictions like the Channel Islands, the Isle of Man and Italy, we will consider putting a cap on the maximum amount of tax payable by individuals, with income above that cap being either completely tax-free or taxed at a much lower rate. Rates for the flat tax and the fixed rebate would need to be decided based on conditions at the time, but our calculations indicate the appropriate level for the rebate will be very close to the amount of the current state pension. Anyone in receipt of both UC and PIPs also receives a similar total amount, and there may be
--	---	--

¹ All figures are from the HMRC's "[Welsh Income Tax Outturn Statistics – 2023 to 2024](#)", published on 10th July 2025.

² Under the current system, the key difference between National Insurance and general taxation is that the latter applies to all income, however obtained, while the former applies only to earnings. There is a plausible argument to be made that this is 'regressive' in the sense that people who rely on their salaries are taxed more (or at least, at a higher rate) than people who have large incomes from investment dividends, rent, capital gains etc. However, the practical political difficulties of moving employer national insurance into general taxation would be significant – effectively giving everyone a 15% pay rise and immediately increasing their income tax by the same amount. This may be a worthwhile reform to carry out at a later time, but for now it has a lower priority than other changes described here.

creating businesses, or to invest in other people's businesses. At the other end of the income scale, one among many factors preventing the long-term sick from taking up employment is the fear of losing benefits and becoming worse off. Apart from placing a barrier in the way of those who would like to work, it means that the wider economy misses out on the value that they could create if they were in work, even if part-time. National Insurance confuses people; originally introduced in 1911 as a way of funding unemployment insurance and rudimentary healthcare, it hasn't been 'insurance' in any meaningful sense since at least the Second World War and has no direct connection with the NHS. Revenue from it is treated in the same way as general taxation, and its only impact upon those who pay it is that it affects entitlement to state pensions, Job Seeker's Allowance and Maternity Allowance.		advantages to making a further simplification using a single amount for each all three cases. While the above changes are expected to be largely cost-neutral, extending it further to those who are able-bodied but not currently in employment – which would in effect convert the 'rebate' into a 'Universal Basic Income' – would not be practical, adding (at current prices) a further ~£500 million to the overall welfare bill. Therefore we'd propose that the basic UC system should remain largely as it is at present, except that we'd want to eliminate, or at least ameliorate, the five-week delay experienced by most new claimants. It is our view that many people who are in receipt of UC are disincentivised from seeking work for fear of facing another five-week wait if they find they lose that work and must apply for UC again.
--	--	---

Education

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
It's a cliché to say that Education is critical both to the economic and cultural well-being of any nation. But it's still true. Our economy has been poorly served by a system ill-adapted to the needs of industry, while the nation's culture has been poorly served by the neglect to teach our own heritage, customs and status. Additionally, many schools have seen their RSE and PSHE lessons used to propagate extreme views on gender and sexuality, even to very young children – this is unacceptable. Wales has fallen down the international "PISA" rankings in the last 25 years, while at the same time England has risen substantially. Compared to schools in England, Welsh schools tend to be much less disciplined, with more tolerance of poor behaviour and a prioritisation of children's 'well-being' and 'mental	We intend to address this as a matter of urgency, by utilising modern best practices from countries such as Estonia, Finland and the Netherlands where state education is of a particularly high standard. At primary level in particular, we shall provide education as close as possible to where pupils live; with an emphasis on small local schools with small class sizes in which basic literacy and numeracy are taught well, stratifying classes based on ability rather than age. Rather than bussing children long distances to attend schools far away from their homes, we would make more use of peripatetic teachers to travel from school to school, making careful use of videoconferencing technology where practical. In primary schools and secondary schools alike, we shall give teachers more authority to instil discipline in class, permitting practices such as same-day detention which are currently permitted in England but not in Wales. Teachers will be supported and backed up by head teachers and local authorities, reinforcing the teachers' authority in the face of complaints from parents unless actual criminal offences have been committed. We shall resist the tendency to diagnose children with disorders such as autism or ADHD, unless the medical evidence in each case is overwhelming. We are concerned that these labels are used too often to	Since education is a devolved matter, we think that the majority of our programme can be put into practice even while working within the existing powers of the Senedd and Welsh Government.

health'. This is counter-productive, since it means that troubled children lack the structure and boundaries that are known to be conducive to good mental health, and are more likely to disrupt the education of other pupils in their class. Our education system is too focussed on academic qualifications, with technical and vocational qualifications being regarded as inferior. This has resulted in a generation of heavily indebted students with qualifications that do not improve their job prospects. It also results in people without academic qualifications being unfairly overlooked for jobs which they are more than capable of doing. Meanwhile, many businesses in Wales find it difficult to expand because they are unable to find suitably-qualified staff, and must either bring people in from outside or relocate themselves.	excuse what is simply bad behaviour, and that applying them too widely makes it more difficult to help children who have genuine physical or mental health difficulties. We shall narrow the scope of RSE and PHSE, to teach knowledge rather than opinions. In RSE this will include an emphasis on the religious traditions that have made Wales distinctive; from the Age of the Saints to Nonconformity. While STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics) subjects will always be important, we shall ring-fence a significant part of the timetable for teaching humanities subjects. Apart from the desire to produce thoughtful, well-rounded young people, there is reason to believe that the growth of Artificial Intelligence (AI) will increase the relative importance of verbal reasoning and creativity, and it is important that pupils are well-prepared for this. In supporting bilingualism – which is now universally recognised as a positive benefit in education, and a way of enhancing pupils' cognitive function across the board - we intend to expand Welsh-medium primary and secondary education to the point where eventually it becomes the norm in every part of Wales. We realise that this will mean recruiting and training a much greater number of Welsh-speaking teachers, and enabling current non-Welsh-speaking teachers to learn the language to a proficient standard. Therefore we acknowledge that in practice it would take at least a decade, possibly more, to reach this point. But the	
---	---	--

	decline in the Welsh language, largely driven by English-only education from the late nineteenth century onwards, took place over many decades and will not be reversed overnight. Further details in the 'Culture' section of this manifesto. We recognise that just because someone is very accomplished within their field and/or a fluent Welsh speaker, they will not necessarily be an excellent teacher. Therefore we shall develop recruitment and incentivisation policies that prioritise teaching ability. The Humanities content of our National Curriculum should be overhauled to prioritise learning of our history, traditions, culture and values. This will give people confidence in their national identity, and pride in their own history. At University level, teaching should be predominantly through the medium of English so that elite academic staff may be recruited from across the world. Welsh universities should be world-class in the quality of their teaching and research, and we deplore the current policy of providing Welsh students with funding to study outside of Wales. This amounts to using Welsh taxpayers' money to subsidise other countries' universities. We think that student funding should only be given for students that are studying in Welsh institutions, other than for subjects for which there are no courses currently offered within Wales, or (such as veterinary science) offered only partially within Wales.	
--	--	--

	Nevertheless we value the benefits of exposing Welsh students to other countries' education systems as well, broadening their horizons and providing access to international centres of excellence in particular subjects. We shall therefore strongly encourage exchange schemes, modelled on patterns such as the UK-US Fulbright programme, to enable Welsh students to study elsewhere and other countries' students to study in Wales. We shall propose the creation of a new regulatory body to ensure high-quality University courses with qualifications relevant to Welsh job market and identifiable skill shortages, and the removal of government funding from under-performing courses and Universities. For admissions, we shall replace UCAS by a new School-University combined application system based on interviews, proficiency tests and grades. We shall not neglect further education, recognising that in the modern employment market people's skills need to be renewed and updated constantly throughout their careers, with wholesale changes-of-direction sometimes being necessary. We shall make targeted training available in cases where companies in Wales face specific skill shortages. We shall encourage everyone of working age to invest in themselves so as to maximise their ability to carry out high-value and satisfying work, and to raise the	
--	--	--

	productivity and thereby the average salaries of the Welsh workforce.	
--	---	--

Civic Service

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
Following funding cuts made by local councils to youth services, after-school clubs and evening youth clubs, the provision of extracurricular educational and recreational activities for the country's youth has waned. In our view this lets down the next generation of citizens, and denies them the opportunity to develop socially and creatively within safe and well-structured environments.	Each secondary school and sixth form pupil should be offered the opportunity to partake in organised voluntary extracurricular educational and social activities, including volunteering, sports with sports science, cadet training etc. This would be made available to young people beyond school age up to 25 years old; participation would be rewarded through a points system which could be counted towards scholarships for higher education, or towards the cost of further vocational or job-based training within Wales. The overall aim would be to instil a sense of citizenship and community responsibility, through voluntary extracurricular activities that will help develop individual character, confidence and social interaction, while also investing in the further educational progression or in the chosen careers of those who choose to partake.	It is expected that the majority of these proposals could be implemented under the Welsh Government's existing powers, but a full review could be undertaken after independence to explore how the scheme could be improved or expanded.

Health

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
The Welsh NHS has a poor reputation, and despite higher per-capita spending has longer waiting lists, longer waiting times in A&E departments and lower overall patient satisfaction than in other parts of the UK. Access to primary care services is patchy in many parts of Wales, especially rural areas, with people having to travel long distances or wait a long time to see a GP or a dentist. Medical staff face high levels of stress and sometimes burnout, which contributes to difficulties with recruitment and retention. There is a stubborn public perception that the NHS is ‘underfunded’, even though total spending since 1948 has increased by a factor of 10 in real terms and doubled as percentage of GDP, and no government from any party has ever cut funding during its term.	In our view, much of the strain on Welsh health services arises from poor matching between primary care (GP and dental surgeries), secondary care (district hospitals and specialist centres) and ‘after care’ (provision for patients who no longer need acute hospital treatment but cannot yet look after themselves. Many people have difficulty accessing primary care - particularly in rural areas - which results in greater pressure being placed in secondary services. This may happen because patients see no other choice than to go straight to A&E departments to receive care, or because in the absence of treatment their conditions deteriorate to the point where this becomes unavoidable. Likewise, lack of adequate after-care provision puts pressure on hospitals from the other direction, taking up beds which could otherwise be used to treat patients with more acute needs. Our first priority will be to enhance primary care provision and so reduce the pressure on secondary care, particularly upon A&E departments, and to reduce waiting times. This will require more primary care practitioners to be made available, since this is itself a major issue. Many GPs and dentists are individually self-employed and work under contract for the NHS, at payment rates (particularly for dentists) that make it impossible to	We are fully committed to the principle of universal free health care, but we don’t believe that the current NHS funding model – where all funding comes directly from general taxation – is optimal or sustainable. The Tredegar Medical Aid Society, founded in 1890, pioneered the concept of a comprehensive, prepaid healthcare service delivered by dedicated full-time medical staff, paid for by regular insurance contributions. However, the Welsh NHS as it currently stands has drifted very far from that model, delivering outcomes far poorer than other countries’ healthcare services which are in fact much closer to the original Tredegar concept. As discussed above in the section on Welfare and Taxation, the current National Insurance system has nothing to do with healthcare provision and it is our policy to merge it explicitly with general income tax. However, we would want to create a more meaningful public insurance system in its place. Outside the UK and US, most wealthy countries combine government oversight of funding with insurance-based mechanisms to provide healthcare that is low-cost at use, universal in coverage, and as good or better than the UK on many health outcomes. We can

	make a living from NHS work alone. At the time of writing, the Welsh Government has recently announced proposals to change the contract basis for dentists, replacing the previous system which dates from the Blair era. Reaction from dentists has been negative, with 72% (in a poll conducted by the British Dental Association³) saying that the changes would make it less likely that they'd be willing to carry out NHS work. We would therefore look for different business models, such as salaried services (which have been found to work well in rural counties of England) or making contracts with whole clinics operating as businesses or co-operatives, rather than individual practitioners. However, we would require that these be locally owned and run, and resist the intrusion of large corporates into this sphere. We would promote the combining smaller GP clinics into 'Polyclinics' which are able to provide a wider range of services locally, including some outpatient services, similar to former 'cottage hospitals'. In particular, these clinics could provide Minor Injury Units which could absorb much of the burden currently falling on hospital A&E departments and provide faster, more local care. Such clinics should be sited in easily accessible locations, such as town centres or near public transport hubs. Larger clinics could even provide short term convalescent care, freeing up acute hospital beds while patients prepare to go home.	see many good examples to follow, especially from smaller countries – Slovenia and Estonia provide particularly interesting case-studies. A key advantage of this approach is that, by explicitly separating healthcare expenditure from general taxation and making it visible, the focus can be moved from political point-scoring over spending and towards optimising the outcomes obtained from that spending. As described in this column of the "Welfare and Taxation" section above, we would do this in the first instance by designating a proportion of total taxes gathered to be "Health Insurance" – included in the existing tax take, not in addition to it. As of the time of writing, the NHS in the UK as a whole absorbs about 20% of total government spending, or ~11% of GDP, so the rate initially allocated to Health Insurance would be based on this. Future governments would of course be at liberty to vary the proportions of Health Insurance and general taxation, or indeed the types of income subject to them, but we'd hope that unlike the existing National Insurance system the link between insurance payments and healthcare provision should remain explicit.
--	--	--

³ <https://www.bda.org/news-and-opinion/blog/wales-rip-to-the-family-dentist/>

	For specialist acute care and elective surgery, services are best provided by larger institutions; but we recognise that this presents particular challenges in a country with as scattered a population and such poor transport infrastructure as Wales currently has. We therefore regard investment in transport infrastructure as a high priority, not only because of its direct benefit to the economy as a whole but because of the extent to which it would facilitate more efficient healthcare provision across the country. Nevertheless we recognise that for some very specialist fields of medicine, Wales's population is simply too small to sustain world-class centres of excellence and we shall continue to use specialist facilities over the border (e.g. orthopaedics at Gobowen, neurology at Walton, paediatrics at Alder Hey, oncology at Clatterbridge, ophthalmology at Bristol Eye Hospital etc.) where this is the best way to provide appropriate care to Welsh patients. We shall ensure that Wales trains enough medical and nursing staff to meet its own requirements without relying on medical staff brought in from outside. Nevertheless, recognising that a thorough medical education may need exposure to specialisms only found in larger centres of population, we would want to see continued collaboration with medical schools in England and elsewhere. Even so, we accept that recruitment and retention of professional staff is a serious problem in many parts of Wales. To some extent this is a symptom of the	
--	--	--

	country's relative poverty, with qualified people gravitating towards population centres where there are better amenities and a higher perceived quality of life. In some cases this may require that higher salaries be offered for roles in particularly challenging areas. We are not opposed to and will not discourage the provision of private healthcare over and above the services provided by the NHS; individuals should be free to obtain medical procedures privately, for example via private health insurance. Private-sector hospitals should be allowed to operate freely, subject to appropriate regulation and liability insurance as is already the case across the UK. We'd encourage a pragmatic relationship between the public and private healthcare sectors where the NHS is able to use private hospitals' facilities to provide extra capacity when needed at busy times, and private practitioners are able to hire NHS facilities at appropriate commercial rates when excess capacity is available.	
--	---	--

Women's Rights and Safeguarding

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
Over the last few years there has been an explosion in the public profile given to so-called "trans rights", that is to say the rights of people to live as though they had a	As a party we have no desire to get into debates on public morality, since we recognise the 'Breitbart doctrine' that "politics lies downstream from culture" and people's moral convictions cannot be meaningfully changed by government legislation.	We think that most of what is laid out in the previous column can be accomplished within the Welsh Government's existing powers, but any items that cannot will be pursued when that power has been increased.

different sex from the one with which they were born. The brunt of this movement has been borne disproportionately by women, with biological men being allowed into changing rooms, public toilets and women's sports. There have even been cases (such as within the YesCymru movement) where rights have been assigned equally to "women and trans people", effectively depriving women of their own rights altogether. Hand in hand with this has been an impetus towards children being diagnosed with gender dysphoria at a very young age, which has sometimes led to life-changing surgery being carried out without due reflection and scrutiny.	However, this is a special case because of the impact it has upon the safety and human rights of specific sections of the population. The only definition of "woman" we shall recognise is "an adult human female", where by "female" we mean "a person with XX chromosomes and born without male sexual organs". Where spaces are exclusively reserved for women, be they bathrooms or boardrooms, only people who answer to this definition of "woman" shall be allowed to enter them. Likewise, "male" shall always be interpreted to mean "a person with XY chromosomes and born with male sexual organs". We recognise that there are people who suffer from genuine gender dysphoria – people who are born with a third chromosome, for example, and people who because of severe hormone imbalances are born with physical characteristics that differ from their chromosomes. Their number is very small – believed to be much less than 1% of the population – and we don't believe that their interests have been meaningfully served by the recent campaigns. We regard these cases as being medical in nature rather than moral, and will follow the principle of compassion towards individuals and scepticism towards movements.	
---	---	--

	Except for such cases, we shall stop public funding for surgical procedures intended to change the apparent sex of people, children or adults. The scope of the 'Green List' where Legal Aid can be obtained for funding clinical negligence (currently limited to neurological injury to children during pregnancy, childbirth or the postnatal period) shall be extended to such cases when privately funded, if the patient later regrets their surgery or in cases of post-operational suicide.	
--	---	--

Adult Social Care

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
This is a fraught topic for every advanced Western country, faced by an aging population and the prospect of rapidly escalating care costs. The issue is particularly acute in Wales because of the phenomenon of retired people from England moving into the country, especially its rural areas, and therefore making heavy demands on the health and social services sectors while not making significant contributions to taxation.	We think that Welsh pensioners should be decently treated with respect and dignity: being provided the services that they require whether in their own homes, which is always to be preferred, or in residential care where this is essential. Nevertheless offering benefits that are significantly more generous than England's while not being able to control the flow of English retirees into Wales makes no sense, and must be stopped with immediate effect. Instead we shall seek practical and pragmatic solutions to this difficult problem so that we offer the best possible care without unfairly penalising other taxpayers.	With independence these challenges become very much easier to manage. By means of residency controls (see later in this document) it will be possible to stem the flow of retirees from England into Wales or, even if they come, then they'd be like those who retire to Spain in that their pensions and benefits would be paid from Westminster's budget rather than Cardiff's. We could therefore build a better care system for Wales's own pensioners (and other adults requiring social care); most likely to be modelled on the proposals of the Dilnot Commission, with spending levels and personal contributions carefully assessed according to the economic conditions current in Wales at the time (though we are aware of the follow-up Casey

Absurdly, it is the policy of the current Welsh government to exacerbate the situation by making benefits for property-owning pensioners in Wales much more generous than those in England, with the 'savings threshold' - below which no contribution to care costs is expected - being £50,000 in Wales against just £23,250 in England. With education funding in Wales being on average £500 per pupil per year less than in England, this amounts to a direct transfer of government resources from poorer Welsh children to richer and predominantly English retirees, and cannot possibly be justified.	This is not an easy problem to solve; possibilities include a sliding income threshold based on number of years living full-time in Wales pre-retirement (with ownership of a second home not counting towards this), or delivering enhanced benefits to people who have tax-paying family in Wales – though this latter option would need to be implemented carefully to avoid unfairness to childless pensioners or to those whose children have moved away. All in all, the difficulty of handling this issue well, within current constraints, is a powerful argument for independence.	Commisson, established in July 2025 and due to report back in 2028, which may revise an update some of the Dilnot Commission's recommendations). In any case our intention would be to implement an adult social care system which is at least as generous as that which we have at present, but only available in its entirety to those who are legitimately Welsh citizens and have paid taxes or drawn benefits within Wales prior to their retirement or incapacity.
--	---	--

Economy

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
The Welsh economy is over-reliant on the public sector and upon 'branch offices' of companies based outside Wales. Too much of the work provided by these institutions is low-skilled and low-value-added, leading to a chronic problem of low pay affecting even areas where the headline unemployment appears relatively low. The third sector (including housing associations, quangos etc.) has become too large, and unaccountable, and this sector needs to be drastically restructured to make it work for Wales. There is a dearth of high-quality private-sector jobs in Welsh-owned businesses, and too few people in Wales own a stake in the businesses for which they work. Those who start up new businesses in Wales are often hampered by inability to attract either investment or suitably-skilled staff. Even those who initially succeed often let their businesses be acquired by much larger companies	Our overriding policy is to prioritise the needs of Welsh-owned companies - moving the Welsh Government's whole focus away from attracting foreign companies to set up operations in Wales, and towards attracting investment into companies based in Wales. This represents a complete break from the economic policies which were initiated under the Conservative government of the early 1980s and have continued unmodified under every Labour government in Wales and Westminster since then. This requires both a shift in the way that Wales is perceived by the rest of the world, and the way that practical policy is implemented from day to day at grass roots level. On the international level, we will no longer market Wales as a supplicant that offers subsidies to outsiders to come and help us out, but as a place of opportunity where businesses are allowed to grow and prosper. Our policy of eliminating the 45% tax rate for very high earners is a key part of projecting that image. We shall make direct appeals to the Welsh diaspora, which includes many wealthy people now based in the US, Asia and the Middle East, to invest in Welsh companies are/or return to establish companies themselves.	While a bloated civil service and excessive government bureaucracy certainly account for part of Wales's unusually large public sector, a significant part of it is also made up of UK government agencies which were relocated to Wales from the 1960s onwards – for example, the DVLA, the Royal Mint and the Office for National Statistics - partly to create employment in Wales. People have rightly expressed concern about what might happen to these jobs after independence. We would privatise these organisations and encourage them to tender for contracts fulfilling their current functions on a contracted basis, both to the Welsh and rUK governments and further afield. For example, besides the UK market, the Royal Mint at Llantrisant has produced coinage for 60 different countries, which at its peak made up over 60% of its total business and gave it 15% of the overall world market for coin production. It is true that this business has shrunk over the last 10 years as world demand for physical coinage has declined, but it is diversifying into bullion production and precious metals recycling. This provides a very good example of what is possible. As part of our radical proposals for overhauling the tax and benefit system and the planning system (see the sections on 'Welfare and Taxation' and 'Housing'), we would want to see overall tax burdens shifted from

from elsewhere in the UK or overseas, rather than retaining ownership or seeking a public listing and growing their companies to the next level. What's left of Wales's 'traditional' industries –such as aerospace and automotive manufacturing – are regarded as 'high carbon' and increasingly rendered uneconomic through carbon taxes and artificially high energy prices. From a climate point of view this is counterproductive – it just causes production to switch to other countries with lower environmental standards while Wales loses the jobs and must still import the finished products.	At the grass roots level, we shall make it as easy as possible to start and grow a business in Wales: - By lifting unnecessary regulations and restrictions, for example reducing some of the certification requirements for skilled trades, when not safety-critical. - By streamlining the business rates and planning-permission system, enabling businesses to build and/or adapt premises to suit their needs [in contrast to the current approach of spending large sums on prestigious 'business parks' that remain largely empty]. - By improving transport infrastructure to expand 'travel-to-work' areas so that businesses can recruit staff more easily and from a wider catchment area (which will be further helped by abolishing the current Welsh Government's 20mph speed restrictions). - By providing targeted and flexible training services to overcome shortages of skilled labour when this hampers the growth of local businesses. - By providing help in seeking investment into companies, at every stage of their growth: however, in contrast to the current environment, any such help will be strictly on-request, unobtrusive, and not a precondition for receiving any other type of support. We will build up a 'Brand Cymru' to draw worldwide attention to agricultural products and manufactured goods of Welsh origin.	corporate profits and placed instead onto personal incomes, while keeping even those taxes as low as they can be kept. Hence in particular, operating profits from Welsh companies would only be taxable when paid as dividends to their owners or shareholders, and would automatically be tax-free if reinvested into the business. This is in complete contrast to the current UK system, where profits can be drawn as dividends without paying full income tax but are subject to Corporation Tax unless specifically exempted (for example, via the highly bureaucratic system of claiming R&D tax credits). Dividends withdrawn would be regarded as income and taxed at the same flat rate as salary income. We think that this would encourage organic growth of Welsh-owned companies with business owners and shareholders incentivised to seek steady growth in order to enhance the value of their assets over the long term. Indeed, investing in a Welsh company would then offer many of the benefits of investing in an offshore tax-haven, in that asset values would be allowed to grow untaxed and taxes would only become due upon 'repatriation' of that value. That said, we have no interest in following the Republic of Ireland's business model of encouraging foreign companies to list in Wales simply to benefit from the lower corporation tax rate. These rules would only apply to companies which, if privately-held, could
--	--	--

	Meanwhile we shall relentlessly look for ways of slimming down the public and third-sectors In Wales, to the extent that the Welsh Government has the authority to do so (see next column). In particular we shall shut down all “DEI” (Diversity, Equality and Inclusion) services, repeal the Well-Being of Future Generations Act 2015, and repudiate both the ‘Nation of Sanctuary’ scheme and support for ‘Net Zero’ objectives. We shall immediately remove all funding to public-sector and third-sector organisations operating to support these programmes.	demonstrate that over 50% of their shares were owned by people resident in Wales, or if publicly traded could show that their global headquarters and a large part of their production capacity was located in Wales. As part of our repudiation of “Net Zero”, we shall completely abolish all ‘carbon taxes’ and restrictions on CO₂ emissions. The UK government’s Climate Change Levy (CCL) would be abolished to bring fuel prices down across the board. Fuel duties on petrol and diesel would be retained at current levels, but recast as a ‘stored energy duty’ and extended to electricity supplied to charging stations for electric vehicles (which we currently calculate would add 2-3p per mile to the cost of running EVs).
--	---	---

Access to Employment Opportunities

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
There are many practical impediments that prevent people who are able to work from taking up employment, especially if they are from very disadvantaged backgrounds. One, as mentioned in the ‘Welfare and Taxation’ section, is reticence about losing benefits. Another is the fact that many trades, even relatively low-to-moderate skill	It is our ambition, simply put, to get Wales back to work by removing every impediment that stands in the way of people taking up employment, upskilling themselves or retraining in order to enter emerging employment sectors. We shall investigate the jobs market diligently to find where such impediments lie, and do all we can to eliminate them. For example, in cases where workers currently require certification to work on government	We think that the actions described in the previous column are all within the competencies of the Welsh Government under current legislation.

ones, are effectively 'closed shops' because of the need to be certified prior to working. For example, programmes such as the Construction Skills Certification Scheme - ostensibly set up to provide assurance that manual workers are qualified in their trades and aware of relevant health-and-safety legislation - have in effect become occupational licensing schemes that place significant barriers in the way of people wanting to join or re-join the workforce.	projects but it cannot be demonstrated that such certification really is essential, then the requirement will be removed. Where certification really is essential to ensure the safety of workers or customers, then we shall facilitate or, if necessary, subsidise the process to ensure that no-one is denied access to the jobs market because they lack the ability to make an up-front capital investment in certification.	
--	---	--

Regulation of Professional Roles

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
The process for recognising professional qualifications (Doctors, Solicitors, Teachers etc.) is cumbersome and expensive, even for professionals trained within Wales, or even the wider UK. This is particularly so for professionals who have taken a career break or worked overseas for a period of time. It can often be quicker to certify someone trained in another country than to certify a Welsh person trained in the UK but who has worked elsewhere.	As with certification for vocational roles, we will do everything we can to streamline this process. Newly-qualified professionals should be enabled to practise in Wales in the shortest possible time. Professionals qualified in Wales should always be prioritised over those qualified within the wider UK, who in turn should always be prioritised over those qualified overseas.	It is not believed that independence is a prerequisite for putting this policy into practice. However, even after independence, we would ensure that standards of professional regulation in Wales remain commensurate with those in England and elsewhere, so that the ability of Welsh professionals to work outside Wales is not hindered and – plans for increased training within Wales notwithstanding – professionals from outside Wales can still fill roles here when necessary.

Transport

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
We are currently the only nation in Europe which lacks a comprehensive internal transport infrastructure. Transport connections within Wales, especially between the north and south, are very poor. The consequences of this are severe, both for the economy and also the health service. While we support the provision of high-quality public transport within and between urban and semi-urban centres, we recognise that over large parts of the country where population is sparse the only viable means of transport is road. This will not change, even with the advent of next-generation technologies such as driverless vehicles. With the proportion of electric cars on the road growing, there is a need to provide charging infrastructure to support them. This is a particular challenge in rural areas, where we don't want tourists in electric cars to be discouraged from visiting but at	Our overarching approach will be to prioritise connectedness within Wales over cross-border transport links. This will benefit Welsh businesses by facilitating both staff recruitment and availability of local services over a wider geographical area. We will press for full devolution of the rail network, to remove the absurd anomaly of projects such as HS2 (between London and Birmingham) and the new East West Main Line (between Oxford and Cambridge) being regarded by Westminster as 'projects benefitting Wales' and therefore cited as arguments against expanding rail provision in Wales itself. To as great an extent as possible in the light of those restrictions, we shall build a modern rail infrastructure across Wales. We shall continue to expand the South Wales Metro across the Valleys, leveraging the planning work already done by Mark Barry, and also in the rest of Wales – particularly where previously-built infrastructure already exists. For example, there are existing track beds that could be used to link Newtown directly to Builth Wells, then Brecon and on to Merthyr; and of course Aberystwyth directly to Carmarthen. There is a strong case to be made for extending the Cambrian Coast line northwards: either to Bangor, or to connect to the Conwy Valley line to Llandudno.	Since most of these matters are already devolved, much of what needs to be done can be achieved without independence. Even so, despite our prioritisation of connectedness within Wales over cross-border transport links, we shall ensure that cross-border transport links by road, rail, air and sea remain unimpeded and maintain existing infrastructure. We do not wish to see a 'hard border'. [See also the section on Immigration and Residency below].

the same time we don't want to despoil the landscape with pylons and large HV switchgear installations. The ongoing saga of Cardiff Airport is a farce, with the Welsh Government spending some £20 million a year to subsidise it while passenger numbers remain much lower than pre-pandemic levels.	We are equally committed to investment in Wales's roads, with a particular emphasis on those running north-to-south within Wales. In particular we shall prioritise the development of a 'Powys Spine Road' along the A470 & A483 corridors to provide a modern road with a series of bypasses to cut the road travel time between the north and south of Wales by at least 1 hour, while improving local accessibility. However, both in the cases of rail and road, our approach will be to make incremental improvements to existing routes where the economic benefits justify it – not 'grand projects'. We maintain, though, that well-built infrastructure can be beautiful, enhancing natural landscapes, and shall give short shrift to those who'd try to rule out any construction work in rural Wales on aesthetic grounds. We shall support sensible approaches to rural EV charging. In contrast to urban areas, there is rarely a need for continuous high-volume current availability, so wherever possible we will avoid the installation of visible transmission infrastructure (e.g. pylons). Instead, we shall encourage the provision of local storage (battery banks, hydroelectric pumped storage, maybe even hydrogen as technology matures) so that utilisation of existing infrastructure can be maximised off-peak. We shall encourage the location of such facilities in market towns, to encourage visitors to	
--	---	--

	frequent them and spend money locally while charging takes place. We shall abolish the current Welsh Government's 20mph rules, and leave it fully to the discretion of local councils to determine what speed limits are appropriate for individual roads. We are opposed to further spending on the M4 east of Newport, where the current Welsh Government has already squandered millions of pounds on feasibility studies to no avail. Many successful economies across the world somehow manage to prosper without an expensive fast road link to London. Instead we advocate peak-hour congestion charging along the M4 east of Newport to discourage daily commuting and alleviate the need for further expansion of this road. We shall cease paying subsidies to Cardiff Airport, accepting the risk that it may have to close as a result. As Welsh Nationalists we're probably supposed to be obsessed with the status that is conferred by having an international airport, but in fact we're much more interested in spending government money responsibly and growing the wider Welsh economy.	
--	--	--

Tourism

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
----------------------	--	---

Wales is known the world over for its dramatic landscapes and world class beaches and astonishingly rich built environment. It has over 600 castles and four UNESCO World Heritage sites. Tourism represents about 6.9% of the total Welsh GDP and supports a substantial number of jobs in regions like North Wales and Pembrokeshire where it's a key economic pillar. Its contribution to our economy is welcomed but there are also concerns. The tourism industry in Wales is predominantly based on low-quality, low-value provision. Large caravan sites blight the landscape in many coastal areas, while people towing their own caravans or motorhomes clog up the already-poor road system during the summer months. Of the 41,000+ static caravans located around Wales, almost all of them are built outside Wales. A high proportion of self-catering accommodation means that people come from over the border bringing their own provisions with them, depriving local shops and restaurants of trade.	Welsh people are proud of their country and are the best-placed to showcase what we have to offer. Our policies are based upon ensuring that income remains within Wales and there are no unintended consequences for the very people whose interests we mean to protect. We do not wish to see Wales becoming unwelcoming, but we want our tourism industry to be more economically sustainable. We want to see a better distribution of tourists, with fewer visiting the areas where numbers can already become unmanageable, and more visiting areas which are hitherto under-appreciated but where more tourism could benefit the local economy. We would like to see Wales compete with other destinations on the basis of quality rather than price, with visitors paying more per head in return for enjoying a higher-quality experience. We want to see the benefits of tourism kept within the communities where tourists stay, with first-rate service provided by locally-owned companies and staffed by local people who do their jobs professionally and with pride. There is a place in this mix for good-quality holiday parks, but we'd like to see plain static caravans upgraded to holiday lodges manufactured within Wales, using local components. On holiday homes and holiday lets, want our policies in this area to be data-driven. Since the Welsh Government's registration scheme is about to come	Subject to the note in the previous column about Small Business Rate Relief, we think that most of these objectives can be achieved within the current powers of the Welsh Government. However we think that independence will be hugely beneficial for the Welsh tourist industry, raising the profile of Wales in the international market and attracting higher-spending visitors from further afield.
---	---	---

Jobs in the tourism sector are predominantly low-wage and seasonal, and often done by migratory workers rather than local people in any case. Second homes are significantly affecting tourist areas in Wales, with both positive and negative impacts. Within less-visited areas they may provide some economic benefits and disperse visitor pressure; however in popular tourist locations, second homes purchased by people from over the border and operating as Airbnbs lead to wealth leaving the country and home-grown businesses suffering. Local people get frozen out of the housing market and many small towns and villages become ‘ghost towns’ out-of-season, with many properties empty and the communities unable to sustain viable shops, schools, cultural activities or centres of employment. To give credit where its due, the existing Welsh Government has been working on a registration scheme for holiday lets which would	into effect we shall make use of the information it provides so that appropriate policies can be put in place for each part of Wales affected by these issues. Until this comprehensive data is obtained, similar to Scotland and England we will allow county councils to apply a council tax premium, up to a maximum of 500%, on all properties not being used year-round as a main residence, with the discretion to vary the premium from ward to ward. We would however suspend the “Article 4” direction introduced in 2024 by Gwynedd County Council, demanding planning permission for changing houses into holiday homes or lets, because the evidence shows that on balance it has been counter-productive. In addition, holiday properties administered as businesses must be available for at least 252 days and let for at a certain number of days in a 12-month period in order to qualify for Small Business Rates Relief (SBRR).The actual number of days required will be a function of the quality of the property according to their “star rating”, so as to encourage investment into raising accommodation standards. For example: 5 stars – 90 days’ occupancy required 4 stars – 135 days’ occupancy required 3 stars or fewer – 182 days, as is the case under current regulations. However, we shall waive council tax surcharges and guarantee SBRR[†] in cases where the property is: • Owned by a landlord who is a permanent resident in the same community, or	
--	--	--

make the scale of the problem easier to quantify. There are also discussions about introducing a licensing scheme, similar to the one that Scotland has had in place since 2022. However, the government has dragged its feet over these, with the registration scheme not coming into effect until the autumn of 2026 at the earliest.	• Owned or operated by a community council or community group made up of local residents. We will introduce a tourist tax at a flat rate of initially £2 per adult (defined as a person over 16 years old) per night on all overnight stays in hotels, caravan parks, campsites, self-catering accommodation and ‘room lets’ (such as AirBnB), where the room is not the guest’s main residence. The only exception to this would be student rooms in University towns, let to students during termtime. Income from this tourist tax will be set aside for projects which will directly improve the experience of tourists in Wales. One example would be the provision of clean public toilets on rural A-roads, with suitable baby-changing facilities etc., to increase travellers’ comfort and prevent the fouling of lay-bys. Another would be the provision of public transport and park-and-ride services in congested areas, which shall be chargeable for day-trippers, but complimentary for people who are staying overnight in Wales for 3 days or more and in receipt of the tourist tax vouchers. No official recognition will be afforded to English-language names applied to properties or land which previously bore Welsh names, whether for tourism or indeed any other reason. Such new names will not be regarded as valid for mail deliveries nor used by local authorities when dealing with the properties in question.	
--	--	--

	† There is some uncertainty in the current law over whether the Senedd has the necessary powers to differentiate SBRR between classes of ownership in the way described here. If not, then we shall make maximum use of such workarounds as are available, such as the extension of ‘Retail Leisure and Hospitality Relief’ which is already administered by local authorities.	
--	--	--

Environment and Natural Resources

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
Wales is blessed with an abundance of natural energy sources, but they are exploited in ways that do not bring proper benefits to the people who live near them or to the country as a whole. Onshore windfarms, for which landowners receive huge subsidies, blight the landscape even in areas where there is little wind and no viable connection to the National Grid. Tidal and hydroelectric power sources go unexploited through lack of investment and political will.	We support a diversity of energy sources including renewables, but we are opposed to onshore wind because of its disproportionate disruption to landscapes and communities. Any subsidies given to such schemes will cease immediately, with onshore wind farms being charged full commercial business rates on all land used by them. Likewise we shall not subsidise the use of agricultural land for solar farms, but will encourage the adoption of solar energy in urban environments. We are very supportive of offshore renewable power generation, whether wind, wave or tidal, seeing Wales as being particularly richly endowed with these resources. We support investment in modern alternative technologies, such as hydrogen, as a way of storing,	The fact that Wales – even after the demise of its coal industry - remains a significant net exporter of natural resources, including both energy and water, would provide financial markets with valuable reassurance about the viability of an independent Welsh currency (see ‘Currency and Constitution’, below) and guard against excessive devaluation and hyperinflation. We would follow the lead of Norway and other successful small-but-resource-rich countries to ensure that demand for Welsh natural resources does not in fact have the perverse effect of leading to an over-valued currency which in turn would make it harder for Welsh businesses to export.

Meanwhile Welsh homes and businesses pay much more for their water and electricity than most of Europe - in the case of water, much more than the places in England to which it is exported. Pollution in Wales's rivers continues to be a serious problem, in many places exacerbated by increased run-off caused by the destruction of upland forests and peat bogs for windfarm construction.	transporting and consuming energy generated by renewable methods. We are not anti-nuclear in principle, but we are sceptical towards large projects such as Wylfa B would have been, that offer poor value for money and provide insufficient benefit to local people. While we are realistic about the technical challenges still to be overcome, we are enthusiastic about smaller-scale nuclear power generation from Small Modular Nuclear Reactors (SNMRs). We will encourage the location of these within Wales, so long as they are there to provide Wales's own energy needs (e.g. next-generation steel manufacturing in Port Talbot), and subject to no direct tax subsidy being provided and local workers and suppliers benefitting from it. We do not subscribe to the 'Nimby' view of objecting to every potential development and recognise that our rural communities are also our workplaces and homes - not just an idyllic landscape to be preserved for tourists. Instead we shall pursue sustainable rural development providing local jobs and services, but subject to proportionate planning controls to prevent over-development and abuse. Within those constraints we will encourage the extraction and use of coal and gas where this can be accomplished cleanly and safely. Likewise we shall encourage the use of wood from sustainable woodlands as domestic fuel in areas of low population density - but not in industrial or commercial contexts, where there is evidence that the RHI (Renewable Heat Incentive)	
--	--	--

	scheme that was introduced in 2011 has led to environmental damage through the use of wood from unsustainable sources and/or contaminated scrap. We recognise that our abundant water resources have been heavily exploited over the years for little or no financial gain. We propose to take all water assets within Wales into public ownership, notably those reservoirs and associated infrastructure operated by Severn Trent, and to place them under the control of existing 'not-for-profit' Dŵr Cymru Welsh Water. Exports of water would continue to England without restriction, but will be sold for a fair economic value. However, we do not believe that the revenues gained for this would be transformative – our best estimates range from ~£40-400 million per annum. Priority for the use of such funds will be given to improving the quality of water infrastructure, including sewage treatment, and lowering water bills for Welsh consumers. The flooding of further Welsh land to provide reservoirs for supplying areas of England will be out of the question. Likewise we shall support the idea of devolving the management of the Crown Estate in Wales, which currently captures a significant amount of the revenue from offshore wind farms. In broader terms, we would choose to see a much higher proportion of the energy generated in Wales being used in Wales – adding value to it by employing it in energy-intensive industries such as metallurgy and	
--	--	--

	even AI data-centres - rather than exporting it to England in its raw form. We are more concerned with the damage that the global climate can do to Wales than the damage that Wales can do to the global climate. Therefore we shall completely repudiate “Net Zero” and withdraw all funding and support for current initiatives under this heading. We shall however spend what is necessary upon sea defences, river dredging and water transportation to assure supply in times of drought.	
--	--	--

Policing and Justice

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
A high proportion of crime in Wales is committed by people from over the border; whether this be due to ‘county lines’ drug-dealing networks, or by the resettlement of people with long-standing drug or alcohol problems from large English cities to areas of Wales with low-cost housing, especially rented accommodation. There are legitimate concerns about this situation deteriorating still further with the housing of illegal	We will ensure the full devolution of policing and justice and the establishment of a Welsh Jurisdiction to bring Wales into line with Scotland and Northern Ireland. We are committed to establishing a national police force, 'Heddlu Cymru' to oversee law and order enforcement; protecting members of the public and their property; maintaining law and order in local areas; preventing crime; investigating crime; and reducing the fear of crime by keeping the peace and providing a better quality of life for all citizens, reflecting the underlying meaning of the Welsh word ‘Heddlu’, namely ‘Peace force’.	We shall oversee the maintenance and further development of an autonomous Welsh legal system, based on the principles of Common Law, maintaining the rights of individuals in the face of state power and in particular <i>habeas corpus</i> and the right to a public trial. We shall leave the ECHR and recognise no legal authority higher than the Welsh Supreme Court. In particular, no Welsh citizen shall be extradited to any other country without the approval of that court.

immigrants sent over from the south coast of England. A high proportion of prisoners in Wales are from outside the country, especially at HMP Berwyn in Wrexham. This increases the likelihood that a proportion of such ex-offenders will settle in the area when they have been released. Wales lacks any women's prison facilities, so women prisoners from Wales have to be accommodated long distances from their homes and families. The UK's membership of the ECHR has had negative consequences not foreseen when the court was first set up. All too often it has created scope for judicial activism and turned the 'rule of law' into the 'rule of lawyers'.	Heddlu Cymru will provide national support for policing but with the delivery of policing conducted by regional services aligned with local government regions. We reject the development of 'Super Prisons' which are mainly used to house prisoners from other areas of the UK. The Welsh prison network should be of a size to serve Welsh needs and not as an overflow for other areas of the UK. We will work through local councils to ensure that prisoners accommodated in existing Welsh prisons return to their home areas after release.	
--	--	--

Housing

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
There is a shortage of social housing in Wales but Local Development Plans do not address this need,	As mentioned in detail within the 'Tourism' section of this document, second homes are significantly affecting the availability of homes within some areas.	As soon as the authority is available, we shall remove the inconsistency of VAT being payable on renovations to older buildings whereas new builds are exempt.

instead focussing on development of commuter estates. A lot of Wales's housing stock is old – early 20th Century or earlier – and the current VAT regime often makes it uneconomical to renovate this, instead promoting new builds which almost always lack the charm of older buildings and harm the character of towns and villages. The situation is especially acute in rural areas where economic opportunities are limited and few well-paid jobs for local people are available, but rising property prices due to demand for second homes make home ownership unattainable for many. Meanwhile local people face competition for jobs and housing from low-paid seasonal workers brought in from outside. At the other end of the scale, over most of the country there is a shortage of 'high end' housing suitable for skilled professionals on high incomes. This can make it hard for Welsh companies to hire senior staff. Many such staff who are employed in North and Mid Wales choose to commute long distances	While applying council tax surcharges is an option, we recognise to do this in isolation, as is happening in some areas, is too much of a 'blunt instrument' and will not solve everything on its own. Indeed, there is a risk that its consequences could be negative if it led to large numbers of vacant properties which were still unsuitable for local families, or if it reduced house prices across the board so that local homeowners wanting to sell their homes for legitimate reasons would be disadvantaged. The only wholly satisfactory solution for this issue is to see local economies become sufficiently buoyant that locals can afford to buy houses at prices which no longer appear 'cheap' to those from outside. We shall reform laws and regulations relating to private rented accommodation; removing what is currently perceived to be a bias in favour of tenants, that discourages landlords from providing and investing in their properties. Instead, we shall encourage the provision of long term leases which carry an obligation upon the tenant to share properly in the maintenance of the property and give the tenant freedom to alter or improve the property for their own needs with the landlord's consent. If a landlord wishes to sell a property, then a sitting tenant should have the right of first refusal and lenders should take account of the tenant's rent payment history in assessing their creditworthiness. Legal obligations upon a landlord to maintain the property to a decent standard during the course of a lease, enforceable by court order, shall be	Over the longer term, we shall manage the economy in such a way that house prices no longer become disconnected from earnings and that the benefits of home ownership become and remain accessible to a much wider cross-section of society – always keeping in mind that a house should be first seen first and foremost as a home and not an investment. We perceive that the principal reason for the explosion in house prices in the UK and many other Western economies over the previous three decades is an excess in money supply provoked by artificially low interest rates, themselves being partly a result of excessive government borrowing. Putting it simply, by flooding the market with too much money, governments have reduced its value relative to property. We propose (see section on 'Currency and Constitution', below) that an independent Wales should eventually have its own currency managed through its own Central Bank, and that stability of housing costs should be one of the criteria applied to the way in which interest rates are set and money is released into the economy.
--	--	--

from Chester or Shrewsbury, or from Bristol in the South, which are then where their personal taxes are paid. There is also a paucity of good-quality privately-rented accommodation, despite the fact that this sort of housing has an important role to play in a well-functioning economy – providing flexible accommodation to individuals and families who neither want to live in social housing nor want to commit to home ownership.	balanced by a more straightforward eviction procedure for tenants who demonstrably fail to comply with the terms of a lease. We would very much like to remove the inconsistency whereby currently VAT is payable on renovations to older buildings whereas new builds are exempt. However, changes to VAT are outside the Senedd's current powers. However, to partially work around this we would provide grants that reimburse the VAT, and possibly provide other incentives such as council-tax relief and tax relief for local tradesmen, when young first-time buyers acquire previously-empty properties to renovate. We would also promote development of suitable homes, whether refurbishments or new-build, for elderly people in the vicinities of polyclinics / 'cottage hospitals' mentioned in the 'Health' section of this document. This would streamline the provision of suitable care and incentivise 'downsizing' to make larger properties available for young families. We shall establish a Wales National Housing Agency with responsibilities for: ● Assessing the needs of Wales in regards to housing across all sectors, and providing guidance and instruction to local authorities when preparing Local Development Plans (LDP) - replacing the role of the Planning Inspectorate in this regard. ● Regulating the multiple third sector agencies and	
--	---	--

	housing associations currently operating in Wales. ● Acting as the central funding body for sustainable social housing developments in Wales ensuring that housing needs of locals are prioritised and delivered effectively.	
--	--	--

Property Tax Reform

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
The way commercial and residential property is currently taxed is complex, hard to calculate and often bears little relation to the true value of the property or the occupier's ability to pay. By disincentivising developments that might otherwise promote economic growth, these tax rules act as a drag on the economy as a whole. Abuses of the Leasehold system cause many people to be trapped in properties that are hard to sell, which besides being fundamentally unjust is also a drag on economic growth.	We shall enact the reforms to Leasehold residential property recommended by the Law Commission in their report released on 21st July 2020, making it significantly easier and cheaper for Leaseholders to acquire the Freehold on their property. Ultimately we would aim to eliminate Leasehold as a form of tenure, as has already been done in Scotland. On commercial property, we shall phase out Business Rates and replace them with a Land Tax, as recommended by the Institute of Fiscal Studies in their report "Tax by Design" dated September 2011. This will be assessed with reference only to the value of the land on which the property is built and the class of planning permission that the land has. Agricultural land used for growing food, or wood for timber, shall be exempt, but the Land Tax shall become payable by the owner of the Freehold from the point at which planning permission is granted. This will discourage the building up of land banks and ensure	We think that most of the reforms suggested in the previous column can be enacted by the Senedd under the new powers granted to it by the Wales Act 2017, but any that can't shall have to be deferred until independence.

Supply of housing is restricted by the practice of developers purchasing land for development but then doing nothing with the land, holding it in a 'land bank' which prevents the land from being developed by others. The current system of Council Tax on residential property, hurriedly introduced in the 1990s as a replacement for the unpopular Community Charge ('Poll Tax'), is a blunt instrument that does not correlate tax payments well with either ability to pay or the value of the property taxed.	that landowners take reasonable steps to maximise the value of their land, or sell it on to others who can make better use of it if they are unable. Onshore wind farms, rural solar farms and woodland planted for 'carbon-capture' shall be regarded as industrial enterprises, requiring planning permission and subject to the same rates as any other commercial business. For domestic property, we shall replace Council Tax by a combination of two new charges: - A Residential Land Tax, calculated as a percentage of the value of the land on which the property is built (excluding the value of the property itself) and payable by the owner of the Freehold. - A Housing Services Tax, calculated as a percentage of the notional rental value (or in the case of rented accommodation, the <i>actual</i> rental value) of the property and payable by the tenant or owner-occupier. It is intended that for most properties the combined value of these two taxes would not exceed the existing Council Tax due upon the property.	
---	--	--

Government and Democracy

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
----------------------	--	---

The establishment of the Welsh Government based on the Westminster model has not worked well, with government functions now simply centralised in Cardiff instead of London. The devolved Welsh Government has acknowledged the need to have a visible presence outside Cardiff, and has built some very prestigious (and expensive) buildings in other parts of Wales; yet these facilities are under-utilised and most people have little idea of what goes on in them. The expansion of the Senedd from 60 members to 96 has been controversial, with many people arguing that it has performed so poorly that expanding it further isn't justified. Yet Wales has a disproportionate number of council seats, at both county and community level, such even large parties often fail to find candidates to stand in each ward. Often, councillors are elected unopposed, appointed undemocratically by co-option, or – especially at community level - many	Since our end goal is achieve independence, we want to see a strong Senedd – one which is ready to take on the mantle of being a fully sovereign parliament when the time comes. The undeniably poor performance of the Senedd to date has been a function of the quality of the people elected to it, rather than the nature of the institution itself. We shall therefore pursue a pattern whereby: - The Senedd is expanded both in numbers and in responsibilities. - The number of county and community councils, and the council seats comprising them, is significantly slimmed down with some of their powers being transferred to the Senedd. - The Senedd itself becomes less Cardiff-centric, with more of its functions, and the Welsh Government's functions, being carried out in other parts of Wales. We shall also bring the roles of the 'Boards, Panels and Trusts' into the expanded Senedd, and expect the functions currently carried out by their appointees to be carried out by elected members of the Senedd. These may or may not be members of the governing party so wouldn't be 'Ministers' as such, but would still be accountable to the Senedd as a whole.	We would like to see real power located in Mid and North Wales, and to that end would propose a governmental settlement in which not only are the various arms of government formally separated into Executive, Legislature and Judiciary, but that these functions take place at different permanent locations so that, like South Africa for example, Wales will have not just one Capital City, but three. We'd propose retaining Cardiff, being the largest city and most important commercial centre, as the Judicial Capital where the Welsh Supreme Court sits. We would also maintain the city's status as Wales's principal financial centre, with the Central Bank located there. We'd propose that the Legislature – the Senedd itself – be relocated to the Sarn Mynach buildings in Llandudno Junction. We'd propose that the Executive – ministerial offices including that of the First Minister – be located in the Rhodfa Padarn buildings in Aberystwyth. Aberystwyth would therefore become the <i>de facto</i> Capital City for practical purposes. It should be noted that we envisage the use of existing government buildings for all these functions, and we would oppose the expenditure of large sums of money to develop additional government buildings in these locations. We would, however, hope that in due course this geographical layout would lead to improvements in the transport infrastructure that connects these centres.
---	--	--

seats remain vacant for want of people to fill them. Not only that, but over and above the Senedd and the county and community councils, there is a whole class of “the great and the good” (or some may call them “The Crachach”) that are paid to populate the numerous Boards, Panels and Trusts that wield significant power over Wales with very little democratic accountability – from the various NHS Boards through to the Disused Tips Authority and the Coastal Erosion Committee. There is no register of political lobbyists in Wales. As a ‘devolved legislature’ it lies outside the scope of the “Transparency of Lobbying, Non-Party Campaigning and Trade Union Administration Act 2014”, (“the 2014 Act”) and therefore no real way of gauging the extent to which Senedd Members are influenced by people representing outside interests (though the Senedd <i>is</i> covered by the National Security Act 2023 which requires a register for lobbyists acting directly on behalf of foreign governments).	Hence the amounts saved on the salaries of these external appointees would also be offset against the cost of the additional Senedd members. We think that this approach will ensure that the Senedd provides better value-for-money overall, and increase transparency and accountability - so increasing confidence in the way that Wales is run. In the same vein, we shall insist upon for the registration and supervision of political lobbyists, beginning with the legislation equivalent to the 2014 Act and adapting it to Wales’s particular circumstances where most lobbying appears to take place on behalf of Third Sector organisations.	Finally, we would consider a role, probably ceremonial, for Machynlleth – the fact that this is where Owain Glyndŵr’s parliament was located is very significant to us. While we cannot justify the expense of developing a centre of government here, we would nevertheless encourage its use as the location, for example, of swearing-in ceremonies when a new government is inaugurated.
---	---	---

Culture

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
Even though the long-term decline in the proportion of Welsh-speakers has been slowed, Welsh-speaking communities continue to wither as younger people move away seeking employment and housing, to be replaced by wealthier English people in search of retirement or holiday homes. Meanwhile, in towns and cities Welsh is becoming an urban middle-class language, sometimes causing resentment among non-Welsh speakers who perceive that Welsh-speakers are given unfair advantages over them. Outside Wales, Welsh culture is often perceived to be parochial, and mocked for its alleged lack of sophistication. While things have improved somewhat in recent years, Wales is still vastly less visible overseas than Scotland or Ireland, which has repercussions for high	Our distinctive language and culture has kept Wales alive and prevented us from being swallowed up into a ‘Greater England’. We’re firmly of the opinion that we must maintain, encourage and widen this cultural distinction as one of our unique selling points. Even so, we must be clearer than ever that Wales belongs to all its people, whether Welsh-speaking or not. This applies too to those areas of the country – such as the Vale of Glamorgan, the southern part of the Gower Peninsula and South Pembrokeshire – where people consider themselves Welsh but where English has been the main language since mediaeval times. We also recognise that ‘Welsh culture’ goes beyond just the Welsh language and encompasses music (classical and popular) and English-language literature, theatre and entertainment as well. Yet the great majority of families in Wales where English is currently the language of the household are descended from families where Welsh was the main language until very recently – rarely further back than grandparents or great-grandparents. We want to make it as easy as possible for families to reclaim their Welsh-speaking heritage and for incomers to assimilate into	We aim to create a truly bilingual society where everyone in Wales has the ability to speak Welsh but can choose for themselves what language they speak from day to day. People who want to speak Welsh should be able to walk up to anyone in Wales, or any private- or public-sector service providers, and use Welsh with a reasonable expectation that they will be understood and responded to in that language. Likewise, people who would prefer to use English, even if they know Welsh, should be free to do so in their day-to-day lives without fearing discrimination or lack-of-respect. We aspire that Welsh culture (including that which is expressed through the medium of English) be recognised around the world, and become an important aspect of Wales’s ‘soft power’ in its interactions with other countries.

value tourism and even for business investment.	Welsh-speaking culture to a much greater degree than has been typical until now. To that end, Welsh medium education will be extended to every primary school in Wales, initially in existing Welsh speaking areas (Y Fro Gymraeg) and ultimately into majority English speaking areas over as short a period as can be achieved. Similarly all secondary schools shall be Welsh medium to age 14, and then bilingual. This is to be implemented progressively following implementation at primary school level, with all secondary schools ultimately becoming Welsh medium. Provision shall be made for supporting English medium education but not including English-only schools. In order to survive and flourish, the language must be a living thing and not just an academic exercise. We shall do all within our power to maximise the use of Welsh in daily speech, and in interaction with both public services and private organisations.	
---	---	--

Heritage

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
----------------------	--	---

Wales's diverse, rich and cosmopolitan cultural heritage has witnessed a great deal of neglect. In schools the history of Wales seems to focus only on two periods, the Romans and Normans, completely skipping the age of the Saints, of the early poets such as Aneurin, Taliesin and Llywarch Hen, of Arthur (or whoever his legends were based upon), Rhodri Mawr, Hywel Dda, Gruffydd ap Llywelyn and Llywelyn the Great. We should not as a nation be only thinking just along the lines of artefacts, and building remains, but also other aspects of our culture. Denmark has seen the importance of the 'community tree', where trees that have been marker's for events are protected. In Wales we have similar living organisms such as the Oak at the Gate of the Dead at Chirk, but in the time since Denmark passed its protective laws we have lost many of our 2,000 year old yews, and 1,000 year old oaks, such as the Pontfadog Oak which was lost without protection in 2013.	We shall strive to protect Wales's physical heritage, reforming Cadw and widening its remit to protect archaeological sites and living organisms. As already stated in the section on Education, we shall ensure that the teaching of history focuses much more upon what makes Wales distinct, and the people and events that have shaped the Welsh identity as it is today. We shall strengthen the legal protections applying to scheduled ancient monuments and other sites of note, making it clear in particular that developers who impinge upon such sites shall be held financially liable for doing so.	We think that most, perhaps all, of what needs to be addressed under this heading falls within the existing competencies of the Welsh Government.
--	--	--

Media

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
Wales receives scarce coverage from the London-based media, while what little Welsh media exists is largely foreign-owned and of very poor quality. This results in the population being very poorly informed about Welsh current affairs – for example, not realising that the NHS in Wales is run by the Welsh government rather than from London – and has enabled the Labour-run administration in Cardiff to get away with shocking incompetence and mismanagement with very little scrutiny.	The media landscape is changing rapidly, with far more people – especially younger people – getting their news online from the major social media channels such as Facebook, TikTok etc. There are some Wales-focused news websites that have come into being over the last few years, such as Bylines Cymru and nation.cymru, but these have not seen significant uptake despite (in nation.cymru’s case) receiving funding from the Welsh Government. All in all, though, this is not an area where the Senedd has a great deal of influence. Any significant changes are more likely to be brought about from grass-roots efforts on social media than from government fiat.	We expect that independence would largely resolve this problem, since there would no longer be any confusion over where responsibility lies and everyone would know that for news affecting Wales they would need to consult Welsh media. We would not advocate the creation of a new state broadcaster – a Welsh equivalent of the BBC funded by a licence fee. Rather, we would privatise the existing BBC Wales organisation and encourage them to compete with other news outlets commercially, while also encouraging them to produce entertainment and drama programmes set in Wales for export to other countries (see section on ‘Culture’, above).

Agriculture

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
Governments in both London and Cardiff are lukewarm about the value of the agricultural economy,	We recognise the importance of agriculture to the Welsh economy and national life. Welsh farmers manage 80% of the land area of Wales; agriculture	With independence it will become possible to market ‘Brand Cymru’ much more aggressively in international trade, and we shall learn all we can from other

seeing food production as subservient to management of the rural landscape for the benefit of visitors and incomers, or even tree-planting in the name of ‘carbon offsetting’ Whatever its effects on other sectors of the economy – and while we remain neutral on the subject overall – there is little doubt that Brexit has caused difficulties to farmers, both in hampering access to European markets and in increasing competition from areas such as Australia and New Zealand. While in principle Welsh farmers could turn Brexit to their advantage by themselves exporting further afield to countries outside Europe, they often lack the capital to develop this side of their businesses. As part of the UK, Wales has had no meaningful input into trade deals affecting agriculture, allowing imports of produce which has been grown under much less stringent regulation than our own. New environmental restrictions placed on farmers by the current Welsh Government – such as the	directly employs 50,400 are employed on farms with gross output of £2.1bn. The food foundation sector turnover is £8.1bn employing 233,500. 43% of workers in agriculture, forestry and fisheries speak Welsh compared to 19% in other sectors. We hold that the primary purpose of Welsh agriculture is the production of food, to the highest environmental and welfare standards. We see no reason why Wales should not have a thriving rural economy providing high-value opportunities for those who live and work in it. We oppose the wholesale planting of vast tracts of trees taking out complete farms and mountains, but we support planting of native trees for environmental benefit, shelter belts, nature corridors, the stabilisation of old coal and slag tips, and flooding control. The forests that exist need to be properly managed, with regular removal of brushwood and appropriate firebreaks. We shall relax excessive environmental regulations, such as the Wales-wide NVZ. We shall do all we can to defend Welsh farmers against the depredations of the Westminster government, working with the farmers’ unions to help farmers legally avoid IHT. We shall encourage investment into Welsh farms to make land more productive without compromising environmental standards: for example by providing	countries with strong agricultural exports – such as New Zealand in particular – in order to maximise the value of Welsh agriculture and its contribution to the economy as a whole. Meanwhile we shall level the playing field on imports, still allowing them but insisting that where imports compete directly with Welsh produce they must be produced according to equivalent standards.
--	---	---

designation of the whole of Wales as an NVZ ('Nitrate Vulnerable Zone'), and the new rules for disposal of sheep dip - are disproportionate, causing little or no change to the environment itself but piling many additional costs and other pressures onto farmers' shoulders. The decision of the Westminster government to make family farms subject to inheritance tax (IHT) is an existential threat to many; while workarounds exist, such as placing them into Trusts, even these cause added expenditures and, once again, pile extra pressure onto vulnerable farmers. The experiment of amalgamating Forestry Commission, Countryside Council for Wales and the Environment Agency into Natural Resources Wales has been a failure. Instead of saving money, it has cost more, and the resulting institution is too obstructive of farmers' and landowners enterprises to maximise the value of their land.	infrastructure to support the use of tracking technology to locate wild animals such as foxes and badgers and so keep livestock safely away from them without having to resort to large-scale culling. Likewise there should be finer-grained testing for the presence of bovine TB, keeping slaughter of infected animals only as a last resort and even then to the minimum possible extent. We shall jealously guard the reputation of Welsh agricultural produce and insist on 'Brand Cymru' being used consistently for Welsh products, giving traceability. We will encourage those producing food in Wales to ensure that it also be processed in Wales, adding as much value as possible as close to the source as possible. To this end we shall create a single Welsh ministry of agriculture, fisheries and food responsible for the whole process 'from gate to plate'. We welcome the establishment of Wales's first school of veterinary medicine in Aberystwyth, but would like to see its offering expanded to provide full five-year courses rather than just the first two years (with the rest of the course currently taught at the Royal Veterinary College's Hawkshead campus in Hertfordshire). Additionally, we shall promote the role of colleges and lifelong learning to support young entrants and older change-of-direction newcomers, teaching both traditional methods and innovative practices including use of IT and advanced environmental sensing technologies.	
---	---	--

	We shall actively promote the share farming scheme, allowing opportunity for new entrants without the capital to buy and helping to reduce the average age of active farmers. We shall ensure that agricultural land remains exempt from the Land Tax provisions that we intend to introduce for commercial and residential property, as discussed in the 'Property Tax Reform' section of this document.	
--	---	--

Immigration and Residency

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
Many areas of Wales, alike in the Welsh-speaking regions of the West and the industrial regions of the North-East and South-East, are seeing local people forced out of their communities as house prices become unaffordable under pressure from retirees, holiday-home owners and commuters from over the border. So-called “white flight”, as people from England face major demographic changes in their home areas as a result of mass immigration from outside the UK, is exacerbating	We think that our proposals for managing second homes, along with our plans for bringing the adult social care system back into line with England’s instead of being significantly more generous, will go some way towards addressing the worst issues currently faced by Welsh communities, especially in the more rural parts of the country. Regarding immigration from outside the UK, we shall immediately cancel the current Welsh Government’s “Nation of Sanctuary” programme and withdraw all funding to public-sector and third-sector organisations operating to support it. We shall categorically refuse to provide accommodation for ‘asylum seekers’ and other illegal immigrants sent over from England, and dismantle the network of former hotels, army sites and	Maintaining an ‘open border’ for trade and commerce is of the utmost importance for the Welsh economy, whether for the trading of goods and services or, where necessary, daily commuting. Nevertheless, Wales should have complete control over who is allowed to buy land and housing, and to take up residence, within its boundaries. We propose that Wales adopt a policy on Immigration and Residency along the following lines, post-independence and to the greatest extent actionable in the meantime. • Complete freedom of movement with unrestricted, document-free travel across all land and sea borders. In particular:

this problem. Some of the more urban areas of Wales are beginning to see similar demographic changes – not yet at anything like the scale affecting England, but still at enough of a rate to cause real concern. Many of these incomers, particularly in rural areas, are older people who place high demands on the health and social care services. Yet they paid no tax or national insurance in Wales during their working lives and, although often wealthy in capital terms, have low current incomes and therefore pay little tax at present.	other properties that is already in place for this purpose. Legal immigrants will be expected to assimilate fully, including placing children in Welsh-medium education and ensuring that, if they want to stay in Wales, they must become fully Welsh and not merely British. Beyond that, however, these are issues which are very hard to address without independence and form some of the strongest arguments in favour of it.	○ No restrictions to be placed on English or Irish residents commuting to jobs in Wales or vice versa. ○ No tolls or customs to be placed at land or sea borders. ● Welsh companies to bear responsibility for correct import/export documentation and payment of any tolls or customs applicable on individual transactions, over a threshold to be determined (likely to be similar to the current UK duty-free threshold of £390). It is anticipated that this will be no more burdensome than current self-assessment requirements for VAT and Corporation Tax. ● The introduction of rules on residency broadly similar to those currently in force in the Channel Islands. In particular: ○ Welsh citizens to have an unrestricted right to lease or buy property anywhere within Wales (though they too will be subject to the proposed council tax surcharges on second and subsequent residential properties) ○ Non-citizens to have the right to lease or buy property subject to: ■ The property itself having been approved for leasing or purchase by non-citizens ■ The non-citizen having received permission to work in or retire to Wales. We will not allow property to be bought by people from outside Wales who do not intend to reside in it legitimately or carry out commercial business within it.
---	--	---

		Also like the Channel Islands, we shall support the residency of Wales of very high-net-worth individuals, subject to them committing to pay at least certain amount of tax and/or invest a certain amount in Welsh-owned companies o Penalties for non-compliance with these residency rules to be applied to property owners who lease or sell property in violation of them. The philosophy behind this approach is that rules and restrictions are applied not to physical movements of people or goods, but to commercial transactions. This shifts the burden of enforcement onto those who are already responsible for enforcing other legal duties such as payment of VAT, corporation tax, council tax or stamp duty. It is not intended or expected that these rules will add appreciably to that burden. It will also be noted that we don't much care about who crosses in and out of our borders, but we care very much about who gets to settle and live here. To paraphrase Martin Luther, "you cannot prevent the birds from flying over your head, but you can stop them from building a nest in your hair". This approach completely negates the need for Identity cards or Digital IDs. Some of the above assumes a concept of Welsh Citizenship. The full qualifications for Welsh Citizenship will be worked out a later time with reference to best
--	--	--

		practices from other small, open countries such as Switzerland or Singapore. Even so, they are likely to include: ● Automatic right to citizenship for anyone born in Wales or born elsewhere as the child of at least one parent who was themselves eligible for Welsh citizenship. ● Right to apply for citizenship granted to anyone who has had continuous taxable employment in Wales, or been married to another Welsh citizen, for a certain period. ● New citizens to be subject to a test for Welsh language proficiency and knowledge of Welsh history and culture: but this test would be waived for people who qualify 'automatically'. In general, residency would not be granted to anyone who can neither show a meaningful pre-existing connection to Wales nor make an immediate and quantifiable contribution to the Welsh economy, whether through specialist skills or financial investment. We see no obligation for Wales to receive refugees who are not citizens of its immediate neighbours, though we would allow it if individuals or private charities were prepared to underwrite the costs of supporting such refugees themselves - without government funding. All Welsh residents (including non-citizens living in Wales by permission as described in the previous section) would be obliged to pay the Flat Tax on all
--	--	---

		income; only citizens would be eligible to receive benefits, including the taxpayers' rebate mentioned in the Welfare and Taxation section.
--	--	---

Defence

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
Wales contributes through its taxes to the UK defence budget, even though the UK's defence assets are disproportionate and wholly inappropriate to a small country such as Wales with no ambitions to be a major international military force. Despite its contributions to the UK defence budget, UK military spending in Wales is modest and consists mainly of the maintenance of large bases such as RAF Valley and SENTA in Sennybridge, which produce few benefits for local people. In contrast, the South West of England has significantly higher spending on defence-oriented manufacturing and technology, producing many more benefits for their local economy.	We recognise the value of the defence industry to the Welsh economy, with major firms such as General Dynamics in Oakdale, Airbus Defence & Space in Newport and Teledyne in Presteigne and St. Asaph, all of which have a thriving export trade to the US and other countries besides the UK MoD. There also a significant number of SMEs and specialist consultancies, predominantly in Mid- and South-East Wales, serving the defence industry and often subcontracting to larger defence firms and UK MoD agencies over the border. The HQ of DECA (The Defence Electronics and Components Agency) is located at Sealand in Flintshire. We shall encourage this to continue and support expansion of this industry where possible, though like elsewhere in industry this shall be by upskilling the workforce and improving infrastructure rather than by providing direct cash subsidies to companies. We shall encourage the maximum possible participation of Welsh companies in the defence supply chain, particularly where this relates to existing military bases within Wales's borders.	We would assert Wales's right, as an independent country, unconditionally to defend its land, sea, air and cyber borders. In practice, though, our preferred way of doing this will always be through diplomacy rather than force, and if the latter then in close cooperation with allies. We envisage that an independent Wales would take possession of UK MoD assets within its borders, as mandated by the Vienna Conventions. While Wales would then cease contributing to the rUK defence budget, it would maintain a modest non-nuclear military force of its own, with an emphasis upon air and sea defence to secure our coasts and ports against smugglers, traffickers and those who may be tempted to see Wales as a 'back door' to the island of Great Britain, as the French did in 1797. No-one wants to see a Russian nuclear submarine in the Cleddau Estuary. In particular, this would mean the creation of one or more naval bases on the Welsh coast, since none currently exist. Somewhere on the Cleddau Estuary

		would be the most obvious location for one, though Swansea in South Wales, and Holyhead and/or Mostyn in North Wales, could also be possibilities. We would also maintain a small land army, recognising among other things the uses of such an institution in emergency relief and training young people with challenging backgrounds. Many small European countries such as Switzerland, Austria and <i>all</i> the Nordic and Baltic states operate some sort of national service, with compulsory military training for anything between six months and two years, and this may be appropriate for Wales too – it could for example form a continuum with the Civic Service concept described earlier in this document. By default we envisage that Wales would remain a member of NATO; but in any case we would take it for granted that Wales would be part of a close military alliance with the rUK to protect the integrity of the island of Britain and its immediate neighbours.
--	--	---

Relations with the European Union

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
EU membership remains a contentious issue. A substantial proportion of people who support Welsh independence were reluctant to see the United Kingdom leaving	It is a simple fact that the current Welsh Government has no meaningful input to the relationship between the EU and the UK.	We recognise that a clear majority of Welsh voters backed leaving the EU in the 2016 referendum, and we see no reason why the subject should be revisited.

the EU, and in favour of a future independent Wales re-joining the EU.	Even so we will strive to keep Wales's profile clearly visible within the countries of the EU, facilitating exports to the EU by Welsh agricultural and manufacturing enterprises at every opportunity. We have noted in the section on Agriculture that Brexit offers significant global opportunities to Welsh farmers, on the scale of the huge success of New Zealand in expanding its global trade since its privileged access to the UK market was withdrawn in 1974, but they are hampered by lack of access to investment capital. Our efforts, therefore, to make Wales an attractive place for international investors shall extend to attracting investment into the agricultural sector for these purposes. We shall pay particular attention to supporting trade through the international ferry ports at Holyhead, Fishguard and Pembroke, recognising their importance to the West Wales economy and seeking "free port" status to encourage high-value industry in their vicinities.	In practical terms, while the EU market is important to Wales, the rest of the current UK market is <i>vastly</i> more important, accounting (according to the best figures currently available) for some 80% of sales by Welsh businesses. So looking at things in 'realpolitik' terms, the idea that Wales could realistically join the EU while the rest of the UK, especially England, remained outside, is for the birds. It would mean surrendering control over our 150-mile long land border, and hinder access to our largest export market. While it does not currently seem likely, there is of course the possibility that an independent England might decide to re-join the EU at some (probably distant) future time. Were that to happen, then a decision about Wales's status would need to be made at that time.
--	---	---

Currency and Constitution

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
The Welsh economy is very different from that of England, and yet we are locked into a currency union with Sterling. Since Sterling's value is determined by England's economy, it	For as long as Wales remains a part of the United Kingdom there seems no scope to address any of the issues under this heading.	We maintain that independence does not <i>necessarily</i> imply Republicanism, and the two concepts should be kept separate. No-one would argue that other countries who have the British Monarch as Head-of-State – such as Canada, Australia or New Zealand, are not fully

often trades on the world currency markets at valuations which are inappropriate for Wales's economy and disadvantages Welsh companies, particularly in the agricultural and manufacturing sectors, who seek to export their produce. Paper money and coins comprise one of the many places in daily life where Welsh people and visitors are reminded that the country's Head of State is the British Monarch, which sits uncomfortably with many people who are aware of Wales's early history and how this situation came about.		independent states that enjoy all the benefits of being so. Our <i>raison d'être</i> is to achieve independence for Wales so that its many economic and cultural benefits can be enjoyed. We suspect, pragmatically, that support for this will be wider than support for republicanism. Our initial goal will be achieve Dominion Status for Wales, similar to the status that Ireland had between 1922 and 1949. Even so, we recognise that post-independence it will be appropriate to have a debate about Wales's long-term constitutional structure, covering the options of: - maintaining the current Monarchy - adopting a new Monarchy (Norway-style) - having an Executive President (US- or France-style) - having a non-executive President (Ireland- or Israel-style). We also maintain that meaningful independence involves ultimately having our own currency, but we recognise that in the short term there would be practical difficulties with this. For the new currency to be taken seriously by international bond markets and accepted as payment by overseas suppliers of goods and services, the government issuing it would need to attain credibility. This means showing it can run a reasonably balanced budget and have reserves available from which to pay interest on the bonds and repay the bondholders when bonds reach their full terms. We accept that during this phase, it would be
---	--	--

		easier to gain this confidence by retaining Sterling, and even so there is likely to be a ‘bond spread’ – in effect higher interest being charged on Welsh bonds than on rUK ones – unless and until the new government proves its competence in this area. Once those conditions are met we shall establish a Central Bank of Wales issuing a Welsh currency. The currency should have 1:1 parity with the Pound Sterling when launched, but thereafter the Bank’s remit will be to set interest rates at appropriate levels for maintaining stable inflation (including hose-price inflation) while allowing the valuation of the currency to be set by the markets. Following the leads of other countries, in particular Estonia, we shall cautiously evaluate the possibility of holding some Central Bank reserves in Bitcoin alongside conventional precious metals, and be sympathetic to the use of cryptocurrencies in the wider economy as the technology matures. We are, however, totally opposed to the concept of “Central Bank Digital Currencies” (CBDCs), which could enable a Central Bank to vary the value of currency according to who owns it. These threaten to be a gross violation of personal freedom and are inimical to the operation of free markets more generally. For the same reason, we shall enshrine a right for people to make payments using physical cash (coins and notes) rather than having to rely upon electronic transfers.
--	--	---

Coalition Government

What is wrong today?	Short term policy – our strategy while working within the Senedd	Long term policy – our aspiration on achieving Independence
Wales has been dominated by the Labour Party at every level of government for at least 100 years. The Labour Party has supplied every First Minister of Wales since the beginning of Devolution in 1999, despite the fact that while always being the largest party Labour has never once won an overall majority. The Liberal Democrats have lent their support to Labour every time, and Plaid Cymru also supported a Labour government in Wales in 2007. The continued rule by a single party for over 25 years has undermined the legitimacy of the Senedd in the eyes of many people, and has led to complacency on the part of the government itself that has in turn contributed to Wales's long-term economic decline.	Gwlad members of the Senedd shall categorically not, under any circumstances, support the appointment of another First Minister from the Labour Party. With that proviso we shall be open to collaborating with any and all parties represented in the Senedd, in order to achieve our overall aims as set out in this Manifesto, but will not enter into a formal coalition.	We recognise that coalition governments are the 'norm' in most democratic countries in the 21st century, and shall encourage the creation of a vibrant multi-party democracy in Wales in which no one party (least of all we ourselves) can dominate the government over an extended period of time. To this end, our preferred electoral system is proportional representation by means of Single Transferable Vote (STV). The principal advantages of this approach is that: • it eliminates the tendency for people to vote against the outcome that they least want, as opposed to vote for the outcome that they do. An underlying reason for Labour's immovability from Wales for such a long time has been the desire to "keep the Tories out", even when positive reasons for voting Labour have been scant. • Unlike the closed list system which has been introduced by Labour and Plaid Cymru for the 2026 Senedd elections, it retains the link between a specific named individual and the geographical constituency that he/she represents.

		Yet we shall also seek constitutional arrangements whereby coalitions do not lead to instability, and in the event of a coalition breaking down then the formation a different coalition should be the preferred option rather than having an additional General Election before the government's full term has expired.
--	--	---

Gwlad,
Dalton House,
35, Chester Street,
Wrexham,
LL13 8AH

07886 399410
post@gwlad.org

www.gwlad.org